

CDN Incident Alert: 0108. TLP: Amber		Date
Title	HU Kremlin-orchestrated Information Laundering scheme subverting Hungarian media ecosystem	11/03/2026

Summary

- Since autumn 2021, a Hungarian-language Kremlin-partnered information laundering website, Orosz Hírek, is translating and republishing EU-sanctioned RT and Sputnik content, which makes its way into Hungarian government-aligned mainstream media.
- Hundreds of Kremlin propaganda-disinformation narratives spread throughout 2+ years, examples given below.
- To degrade Ukraine and cultivate support for Russia, the operation is leveraging an existing inauthentic news site, having it machine translate the sanctioned media content, and republishing it as its own before having Hungarian media republish it, in most cases forgoing references to Orosz Hírek.
- Hundreds of thousands of Hungarians are consuming translated, obfuscated RT and Sputnik content, presented to them directly by the popular layering site, and indirectly by high-trust government-aligned mainstream media.
- Case submitted to the Hungarian branch of EDMO. Highlighting the illegal operation to Meta, Google, and X in January 2026. Only YouTube replied and removed the violating content.

Incident

Between January 1, 2022, and March 10, 2024, four Hungarian government-affiliated outlets have republished 891 laundered articles, originally from the columns of the EU-sanctioned Russian media RT and Sputnik. These illegal articles have been republished as if they originated from the Hungarian-language website Orosz Hírek, a Kremlin proxy which worked to mask the origin of the RT and Sputnik articles. Orosz Hírek, a Kremlin-proxy 'copy-paste' site, having laundered at least 2,824 pieces from sanctioned Russian sources. Orosz Hírek openly declared in their YouTube description that Ruptly, a RT-owned company, is their content provider partner.

The operation is in violation of Article 2f (1) of Council Regulation (EU) 2022/350 and Article 4g of Council Decision (CFSP) 2022/351, which outlaws the (re)distribution of RT and Sputnik content in any form.

Narrative

Meta-narratives: The Ukrainian government fails to uphold democratic standards and the rule of law; Degradation of the West; Russia threatened by NATO.

Sub-narratives: Ukraine is committing war crimes; Ukraine sympathises with the ideas of Nazism; Ukraine is an untrustworthy ally involved in various misdeeds; Western countries are responsible for energy shortages and rising prices; NATO weapons used by Ukraine to target civilians

Impact

Reach: Orosz Hírek has 198,000 followers on Facebook, with an actively engaged community, 13,100 followers on X, nearly 20,000 subscribers on Telegram, and 7,200 subscribers on YouTube.

Outcome: Beyond its direct reach, Orosz Hírek provides a prolific avenue for Russian propaganda and disinformation into Hungarian government-aligned mainstream media. Reach example: A key piece of [RT-fabricated disinformation](#), laundered via [Orosz Hírek](#), and covered by mainstream [pro-government media](#), reached at least 31,037 users (combined engagements, paid advertisement impressions) on Mandiner's (pro-government outlet) Facebook site.

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

Objective: [T0066: Degrade Adversary](#) – the articles promoted degrade Ukraine.

Objective: [T0136.006: Cultivate Support for Ally](#) – the operation promotes the Orbán regime and tries to reinforce the Hungarian domestic perception of Russia.

[T0098.002: Leverage Existing Inauthentic News Sites](#) – RT-owned Ruptly set up collaboration with existing fringe Orosz Hírek, and turned it into a sanctions evasion 'copy-paste' site.

[T0085.008: Machine Translated Text](#) - Orosz Hírek is machine translating content to Hungarian from RT and Sputnik.

[T0129.003: Break Association with Content](#) - Orosz Hírek also hides the origin of the RT and Sputnik content, publishing it as its own original content.

[T0117: Attract Traditional Media](#) – Leveraging Orosz Hírek to inject laundered content into Hungarian

government-aligned mainstream media.

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Action taken: The contributor is collaborating with the Hungarian Digital Media Observatory (Lakmusz) to author an exposé article, both covering Orosz Hírek, and complicit Hungarian government aligned media. Escalated the case to Meta, Google, and X, asking them to address the systemic sanction violation through geofencing or takedown. Google took action, taking down violating videos. Other actors did not reply.

Recommendations: Inform complicit Hungarian-government aligned media of the sanctions evasion; Potentially escalate to the national regulator to go after complicit mainstream media, political pushback expected.

Report	Threat Actor	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	Logo
Link	Russia	Databases	Domonkos D Kovacs, Independent Researcher	Website, Facebook, YouTube, Telegram	X,